

The Creator Paradox: How Creator Enablement Generates Ethical Vulnerabilities, Parental Trust Erosion, and Subscription Churn in Faith-Based Children’s Streaming Platforms

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Abstract

Subscription video-on-demand and educational technology platforms targeting faith-conscious families increasingly rely on independent content creators to scale their libraries, accelerate velocity, and reduce production overhead. However, this strategy introduces a severe strategic dilemma termed the Creator Paradox. While creator enablement supports rapid platform growth, it introduces behavioral variance, incentive drift, and off-platform reputational exposure that traditional content moderation fails to mitigate. This study shifts the primary analytical lens from defensive content moderation to actor-level creator governance. By synthesizing platform governance theory, stakeholder theory, institutional trust theory, ethical consumption literature, and consumer exit models, this paper proposes Parent-Funded Ethical Withdrawal (PFEW) as a theoretically grounded extension of ethical consumer exit behavior in subscription platform ecosystems. PFEW conceptualizes how moral misalignment between third-party creators and parental end-users converts directly into financial churn due to perceived moral complicity. To address this risk, the paper presents five testable conceptual propositions and introduces the Faith-Based Creator Governance Model (FCGM), a four-tiered strategic framework derived from multi-sided governance and organizational trust control mechanisms. This framework offers executive platform leaders a roadmap to reconcile ecosystem scalability with institutional trust and subscription retention.

1 Introduction

The global expansion of subscription video-on-demand services and educational technology platforms has created specialized market niches catering to faith-conscious consumers. In these markets, platforms promise safe, educational, and values-aligned environments for children. To maintain content velocity and compete with open video networks, platform managers increasingly adopt creator enablement strategies. By onboarding independent creators, digital platforms expand their catalog diversity, foster cultural relevance, and outsource creative capital. However, this ecosystem growth mechanism gives rise to a critical strategic dilemma known as the Creator Paradox. The decentralized autonomy that makes external creators agile and engaging simultaneously generates behavioral variance and commercial incentives that can conflict with the platform’s core identity.

Most contemporary research on digital platform risk focuses on automated content moderation, algorithmic safety, and surface-level policy enforcement [1, 5]. This paper argues that such a focus addresses symptoms rather than structural root causes. The central vulnerability facing faith-based media ecosystems is not fundamentally a content moderation failure, but a creator governance failure. Content moderation evaluates isolated digital artifacts against explicit baseline rules, whereas creator governance manages the ongoing incentives, personal integrity, and off-platform behaviors of ecosystem participants [2, 4]. When platform operators rely on automated filters or post-publication reviews, sub-threshold ethical misalignments and off-platform controversies slip through undetected, damaging parental trust and eroding brand legitimacy.

To guide platform executives through these distinct failure modes, Figure 1 categorizes platform operational threats along two strategic axes: detection difficulty and churn impact. Traditional overt content risks, such as explicit violence or profanity, occupy the upper-left quadrant because automated filters detect them with high accuracy before public release [5]. In contrast, creator governance risks occupy the high-impact, high-difficulty quadrant in the upper-right. These risks include sub-threshold value shifts, hyper-commercialized messaging, and off-platform personal scandals [4, 9]. Automated moderation algorithms cannot evaluate context, theological nuances, or personal behavior across external social media platforms. Consequently, unmitigated creator governance failure represents an invisible threat that bypasses standard digital firewalls and strikes directly at consumer trust.

The primary objective of this paper is to examine how creator enablement generates structural governance vulnerabilities that destabilize subscriber retention in faith-based streaming ecosystems. Five central sub-questions guide this inquiry: what specific ethical vulnerabilities emerge when independent creators contribute to values-driven children’s platforms; how do creator monetization incentives conflict with platform educational missions; how do parents perceive and react to creator-related ethical risks; through what behavioral mechanisms does creator misalignment cause subscription cancellations; and what operational governance framework can mitigate these ecosystem failure modes while preserving platform scale.

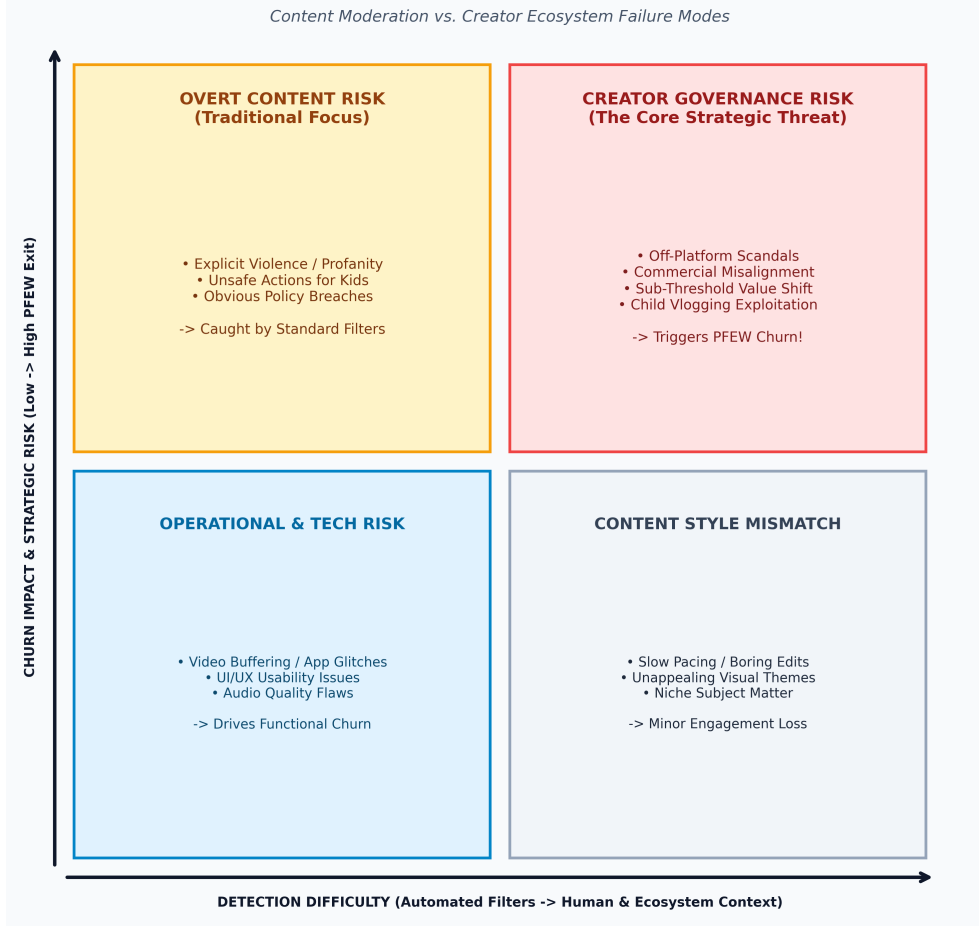


Figure 1: The Governance Risk Matrix illustrating how creator governance risks combine high detection difficulty with severe ethical churn impact compared to traditional content moderation.

2 Theoretical Foundations

Building a rigorous model of creator governance requires synthesizing several distinct academic disciplines: platform governance theory, stakeholder theory, organizational trust theory, ethical consumption literature, digital religion scholarship, and consumer exit economics. Platform governance theory establishes that multi-sided digital architectures act as private regulatory institutions [1–3]. Platforms do not merely host neutral content; they design rules, structure markets, and shape participant behaviors [1, 4]. When platforms delegate content production to independent micro-entrepreneurs, systemic risk shifts from platform operations to ecosystem participants [3, 4]. Effective governance therefore requires governing the structural incentives and conduct of ecosystem participants rather than performing manual file curation [2, 5].

Stakeholder theory provides the theoretical foundation for modeling the conflicting interests of ecosystem actors [15, 16]. In faith-based media ecosystems, four primary stakeholder groups interact: platform executives, independent creators, parent purchasers, and child end-users. Platform operators seek platform growth, market share, and subscriber retention. Independent creators seek audience expansion, monetization, and creative freedom [6, 7, 9]. Parents, operating as primary moral stewards, demand value integrity, pedagogical safety, and cultural

authenticity. Because independent creators are incentivized by platform logics and algorithmic lore to optimize for view duration and engagement hooks [7, 9, 10], their financial incentives diverge from the protective standards demanded by paying parents.

Organizational trust theory and digital religion scholarship explain how consumer confidence is established and damaged in values-driven markets [11, 12, 14, 26]. Perceived integrity and benevolence form the core of institutional trust [11]. Recent platform trust research demonstrates that institutional trust in multi-sided platforms operates hierarchically: user confidence in the hosting ecosystem transfers to complementors, but severe behavioral breaches by individual creators collapse overall institutional credibility [14]. Parents subscribe to niche faith-based streaming services to outsource media curation to a trusted institutional delegate [26, 27]. Digital religion scholarship confirms that authority in online faith spaces relies on networked trust and perceived authenticity [26]. When an onboarded creator behaves inappropriately on or off the platform, parents perceive a systemic failure in institutional integrity [12, 14]. Trust erosion is compounded by e-commerce dynamics, where subscription continuity relies on ongoing brand legitimacy [13, 28].

Ethical consumption literature and economic exit theory provide the final theoretical link explaining subscriber churn [17, 19–21]. Hirschman’s Exit, Voice, and Loyalty framework establishes that consumers respond to quality decline either by expressing dissatisfaction through communication channels or by terminating economic support through market exit [17]. In high-involvement moral consumption contexts, service switching behavior occurs rapidly when trust is compromised [18]. Research in ethical consumption demonstrates that morally conscious buyers view purchasing decisions as extensions of personal identity and social responsibility [20, 21]. When consumers perceive corporate or supplier wrongdoing, ethical dissonance drives direct punitive purchasing behavior [19, 30, 31]. Media literature highlights heightened parental sensitivity around digital exposure, child privacy, and influencer monetization [24, 25]. When combined with religious consumer behavior literature [27, 28], these frameworks demonstrate that faith-conscious parents treat digital subscriptions as active moral transactions.

3 The Creator Governance Vulnerability Framework

To systematically map platform failure modes, this section establishes five distinct vulnerabilities introduced by creator enablement strategies. The first vulnerability is mission drift driven by incentive divergence. External creators trained on open social media platforms often optimize for sensationalism, rapid pacing, and clickbait narrative structures to maximize audience retention [6, 7]. When brought into a faith-based educational environment, these commercial habits encourage low-brow humor and shallow educational engagement [4]. The creator optimizes for short-term viewer metrics, while the platform’s overarching identity suffers a decline in pedagogical and ethical depth.

The second vulnerability involves child participation and exploitation risks. Many independent creators produce family vlogging content, child-led roleplay, or unboxing videos featuring real children [25]. This production model introduces complex ethical questions concerning child labor standards, privacy exposure, and commercial sharenting [24, 25]. Parents who subscribe

to a platform to escape commercialized media environments react negatively to content that appears to commodify child performance or broadcast private family dynamics for profit.

The third vulnerability is sub-threshold ethical misalignment. Content produced by external creators often complies technically with explicit policy guidelines prohibiting overt vice, profanity, or graphic violence [5]. However, the content may still violate the underlying spirit of religious norms through subtle themes of materialism, vanity, or disrespectful interpersonal dynamics [27]. Because automated filters evaluate binary rule compliance, sub-threshold violations pass moderation checks easily, resulting in a persistent disconnect between automated platform approval and parental expectations.

The fourth vulnerability is reputation contagion and off-platform spillover. Independent creators maintain personal digital footprints across external networks including Instagram, TikTok, podcasts, and personal vlogs [8,9]. If an onboarded creator engages in off-platform controversy, expresses objectionable personal opinions, or exhibits behavior incompatible with platform values, parents experience moral dissonance [22,29]. The creator’s external conduct contaminates the hosting platform’s brand equity, creating an immediate reputational crisis even if the specific videos hosted on the platform remain clean.

The fifth vulnerability is operational dependence and monitoring debt. As a platform expands its catalog by onboarding dozens of independent creators, the administrative complexity of manually auditing every asset grows exponentially [1,4]. Reliance on third-party production leads to inconsistent video quality, fragmented educational outcomes, and severe monitoring debt. Over time, the internal resources required to audit external creators eclipse the initial cost savings of outsourcing production, placing platform operations under strain.

4 Conceptualizing Parent-Funded Ethical Withdrawal

To capture the specific consumer mechanism driving subscription cancellation in values-aligned digital platforms, this paper proposes Parent-Funded Ethical Withdrawal (PFEW) as a theoretically grounded extension of ethical consumer exit behavior in subscription platform ecosystems. PFEW is formally defined as the deliberate termination of a recurring subscription transaction by a primary purchasing stakeholder, triggered by the perception that platform revenues are being redistributed to ecosystem participants whose off-platform behavior, content, or commercial incentives violate the buyer’s moral, religious, or ethical standards.

Figure 2 maps the complete causal chain of the PFEW pathway across three distinct operational domains. In the first phase, platform strategy prioritizes creator enablement and grants high operational autonomy to accelerate library scaling. In the second phase, ecosystem dynamics take hold as unmonitored creator autonomy generates ethical variability, sub-threshold misalignment, and mission drift. When parents observe this variance, institutional trust breaks down. In the third phase, consumer response manifests not as functional dissatisfaction with software performance, but as moral objection. The parent recognizes that their recurring subscription fee funds the platform’s pool of creator payouts. Subscribing is thus re-evaluated as an act of indirect financial endorsement of compromised actors [30]. To resolve this moral dissonance, the parent executes an immediate financial exit.

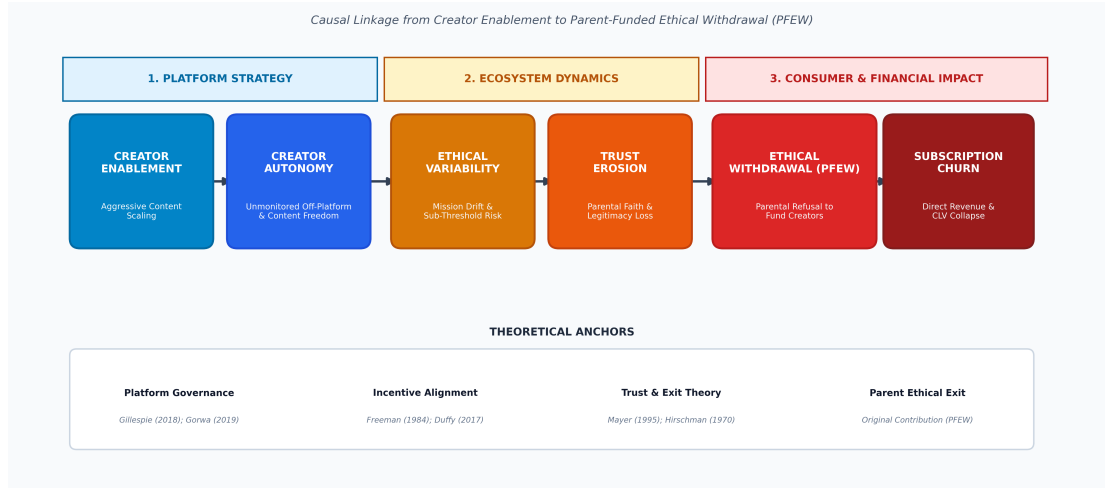


Figure 2: The PFEW Causal Pathway Model illustrating how creator enablement decisions propagate through ecosystem dynamics to generate subscription churn and financial loss.

To establish theoretical clarity, PFEW must be distinguished from related constructs in marketing, platform management, and organizational behavior. Table 1 outlines the core differences separating PFEW from functional churn, ethical consumer boycotts, and psychological contract breaches.

Table 1: Comparative Conceptual Matrix: Distinguishing PFEW from Related Consumer Behaviors

Dimension	Functional Churn	Ethical Consumer Boycott	Psychological Contract Breach	Parent-Funded Ethical Withdrawal (PFEW)
Primary Driver	Utility, price, or software interface failure	Public activism to pressure corporate policy	Organizational breach of implicit promises	Moral complicity from funding misaligned creators
Consumer Mindset	Transactional frustration	External political or social campaign	Personal betrayal by firm or employer	Ethical tension and delegated moral stewardship
Reversibility	High (via discounts or bug fixes)	Moderate (upon corporate compliance)	Low (requires extensive trust rebuilding)	Very Low (irreversible values-based exit)
Scope of Impact	Individual silent cancellation	Organized public pressure campaign	Internal disengagement or turnover	Micro-network viral exit and moral eWOM

As detailed in Table 1, functional churn is driven by transactional dissatisfaction, such as video buffering, high subscription pricing, or unappealing user interface design [18]. Functional churn is price-elastic and reversible through technical fixes or promotional discounts. An ethical consumer boycott is an organized, public campaign designed to pressure a corporation into altering its policy [19,22]. A psychological contract breach involves a sense of personal betrayal when an organization violates implicit commitments made to employees or consumers [12]. In contrast, PFEW is an uncoordinated, values-based consumer exit occurring within subscription economies. It is driven by a parent’s internal need to avoid moral complicity in funding

third-party creators whose actions violate household ethical standards. Empirical research in consumer purchasing confirms that monetary discounts fail to offset moral dissonance when core identity values are breached [21,30,31], rendering PFEW churn largely irreversible.

To ensure analytical rigor across future empirical studies, Table 2 provides formal definitions, operational scopes, and theoretical anchors for all key variables in the proposed framework.

Table 2: Construct Definitions, Operational Scopes, and Theoretical Anchors

Construct Name		Formal Definition and Operational Scope	Theoretical Anchors
Creator Autonomy		The degree of operational and narrative freedom granted to independent complementors without pre-publication screening.	Platform Governance [1, 4]; Cultural Production [4,9]
Content Variability	Ethical	The degree of variance in ethical tone, pedagogical depth, and value alignment across third-party media assets.	Ecosystem Risk [3,5]; Algorithmic Lore [9,10]
Parental Erosion	Trust	The institutional degradation of perceived integrity, ability, and benevolence assigned to the platform operator by purchasing parents.	Organizational Trust [11,12]; Platform Ecosystem Trust [14]
Parent-Funded Ethical Withdrawal (PFEW)	With-	The cancellation of recurring subscriptions driven by a parent’s desire to avoid indirect moral complicity in funding third-party creators.	Ethical Exit [17, 19]; Moral Dissonance [20,31]
Parent Availability	Voice	The presence of institutional communication channels enabling parents to escalate concerns directly to platform management.	Exit-Voice Theory [17]; Consumer Activism [22, 32]
Value-Aligned Monetization		Monetization structures rewarding complementors based on ethical compliance and pedagogical impact rather than view volume.	Stakeholder Incentive Alignment [15,16]; Contract Theory [4]

5 Formal Conceptual Model and Propositions

To formalize the theoretical framework for future empirical evaluation, this section develops five testable conceptual propositions linking platform governance choices, creator dynamics, parental trust, and subscription outcomes.

The first proposition addresses the relationship between creator autonomy and content variability. When platform managers grant operational autonomy to external creators without ex-ante vetting or behavioral guardrails, creators default to audience growth techniques learned on open social media networks [6,9]. This behavioral divergence creates inconsistency in pedagogical tone and ethical orientation across the platform’s catalog. Therefore, the paper posits:

Proposition 1 (P1): Higher levels of third-party creator autonomy in values-aligned streaming ecosystems lead to increased content ethical variability and mission drift.

The second proposition links content variability with institutional trust. Parents subscribe to niche faith-based services specifically to delegate content curation to a trusted institutional intermediary [26,27]. When parents encounter sub-threshold ethical misalignments or off-platform scandals involving onboarded creators, they perceive the platform operator as failing in its institutional stewardship duty [11,14]. Therefore, the paper posits:

Proposition 2 (P2): Increased content ethical variability directly accelerates parental trust erosion regarding the platform’s institutional integrity.

The third proposition connects trust erosion to consumer exit behavior. In recurring subscription models, parental trust serves as the primary psychological contract maintaining customer retention. When trust breaks down due to perceived moral misalignment, parents re-evaluate their recurring subscription payments as an unwanted financial endorsement of misaligned creators [19, 30]. This moral dissonance triggers immediate economic exit to relieve feelings of ethical complicity. Therefore, the paper posits:

Proposition 3 (P3): Parental trust erosion positively drives Parent-Funded Ethical Withdrawal (PFEW), resulting in direct subscription churn motivated by moral complicity avoidance.

The fourth proposition examines the moderating role of parent voice mechanisms. According to Hirschman’s economic theory, consumers who encounter service decline choose between exit and voice [17]. When platforms establish accessible voice channels, such as parent advisory panels, direct reporting tools, and transparent escalation processes, parents can express dissatisfaction without immediately terminating their financial support. Effective voice mechanisms provide an operational buffer that absorbs parental concern before trust collapses entirely. Therefore, the paper posits:

Proposition 4 (P4): The availability of functional parent voice mechanisms negatively moderates the relationship between parental trust erosion and PFEW exit intention, such that strong voice channels reduce immediate subscriber churn.

The fifth proposition evaluates the impact of value-aligned creator incentives. Creator behavior is heavily shaped by platform monetization algorithms [4, 10]. When platform operators replace pure view-count payout structures with weighted monetization models that reward pedagogical quality, character development, and value alignment, creator incentives align directly with parental expectations. This incentive alignment stabilizes content quality and protects platform brand equity. Therefore, the paper posits:

Proposition 5 (P5): Aligning creator monetization structures with ethical and pedagogical metrics negatively influences content ethical variability, thereby reducing overall ecosystem churn risk.

6 Commercial and Strategic Impact Analysis

The financial consequences of unmitigated creator governance risk extend far beyond isolated subscription cancellations. In subscription business models, unit economics rely heavily on Customer Lifetime Value (CLV) and low Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC). PFEW directly compresses CLV by shortening average subscription tenure. When ethical controversies trigger systemic cancellations, customer acquisition costs spike because marketing campaigns must work harder to overcome persistent negative brand associations in tight-knit parent communities.

Furthermore, PFEW accelerates negative electronic word-of-mouth across parent messaging networks, online forums, and community associations. Recent research on brand cancellation dynamics and negative word-of-mouth confirms that digital consumer activism operates virally, spreading rapidly through shared value networks [22, 32]. Faith-conscious consumer segments

operate through dense social networks bound by shared values [27, 28]. A single publicized instance of creator misconduct or moral misalignment can trigger waves of subscription cancellation within tightly connected parent communities [22, 32]. In these environments, churn does not remain an isolated customer decision; it manifests as a collective consumer exit that cripples organic growth and word-of-mouth referrals.

At the institutional level, creator governance failures undermine brand legitimacy among critical strategic partners. Institutional legitimacy theory demonstrates that organizations depend on external endorsement networks to maintain operational standing [23, 29, 33]. Faith-based platforms depend on formal and informal endorsements from religious scholars, educational institutions, community leaders, and ethical venture capital investors [26]. When creator scandals occur, institutional endorsers withdraw their backing to protect their own moral authority [23, 29, 33]. The loss of institutional endorsement destroys brand defensibility, exposing the platform to competition from traditional media providers and alternative educational services.

7 The Faith-Based Creator Governance Model

The four tiers of the Faith-Based Creator Governance Model (FCGM) are derived from four recurring governance mechanisms identified across stakeholder governance, organizational trust management, multi-sided platform control, and consumer accountability literature [1, 11, 15, 17]. Rather than imposing arbitrary administrative steps, each tier maps to a specific theoretical vulnerability point in ecosystem management: pre-entry screening addresses ex-ante adverse selection, continuous auditing manages moral hazard, voice integration provides feedback buffers to prevent exit, and value-based incentives eliminate underlying reward misalignments.

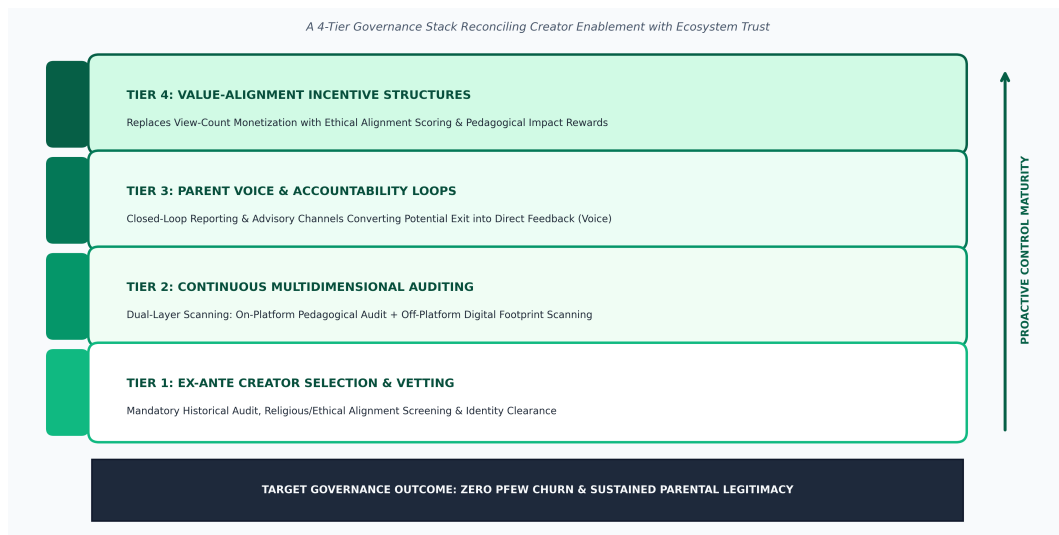


Figure 3: The Faith-Based Creator Governance Model (FCGM) displaying the four-tier proactive operational stack required to maintain ecosystem trust.

As shown in Figure 3, FCGM structures governance controls into four distinct operational tiers, building from foundational selection mechanisms up to advanced incentive alignment. Tier 1 establishes ex-ante creator selection and vetting controls. Before granting publishing

access, platform managers conduct comprehensive background audits of candidate creators. This screening evaluates historical public conduct, off-platform social media footprints, theological alignment, and pedagogical suitability. Mandatory orientation programs ensure that creators understand the platform’s value baseline and institutional expectations before content co-creation begins.

Tier 2 implements continuous multidimensional auditing. Rather than relying on one-time background checks, the platform maintains a dual-layer scanning architecture. The first layer performs regular pedagogical and ethical reviews of on-platform media assets. The second layer monitors off-platform digital footprints to detect emerging reputational risks before they generate consumer backlash [4, 8]. By auditing creator conduct across both hosted assets and external channels, the platform protects itself against reputation contagion.

Tier 3 integrates parent voice and accountability loops. Grounded in Hirschman’s economic theory, this tier provides transparent communication and reporting mechanisms that allow parents to express concerns directly to platform administrators [17]. When parents possess accessible voice channels, such as dedicated review boards, direct escalation pathways, and advisory panels, they are far less likely to execute an immediate moral exit (PFEW). Parent voice acts as an early warning system, allowing platform managers to apply corrective governance before trust erosion turns into financial churn.

Tier 4 establishes value-alignment incentive structures that alter the fundamental economics of creator monetization. Traditional video platforms reward creators strictly based on view counts, click-through rates, and session duration, incentivizing sensationalism and low-brow engagement hooks [6, 7, 10]. FCGM replaces pure view-count monetization with a weighted scoring matrix. Creator payouts are tied to verified value alignment, pedagogical quality, character-building outcomes, and parental approval ratings. By aligning financial rewards with institutional mission, Tier 4 eliminates the structural incentive misalignment at the root of the Creator Paradox.

8 Strategic Implementation and Managerial Guidance

Operationalizing the Faith-Based Creator Governance Model requires integrating governance protocols into core platform software architectures. Digital asset management systems should embed automated metadata tagging for creator audit trails, enabling platform managers to trace content provenance and compliance scores in real time. Creator portals must provide transparent dashboards displaying alignment metrics, pedagogical feedback, and revenue allocations, fostering a collaborative partnership between the platform operator and third-party creators [4].

A central managerial challenge in executing FCGM is balancing strict governance enforcement with creator autonomy and creative freedom. Over-regulation risks alienating top creative talent and smothering narrative innovation [6, 7]. To maintain ecosystem vibrancy, executive managers should establish clear, predictable guardrails rather than micro-managing creative execution. Creators should retain freedom over artistic expression, visual style, and storytelling techniques, provided their content and conduct remain within established ethical and pedagogical

ical bounds.

When creator violations occur, platform operators must execute decisive offboarding protocols. Indecisive or delayed administrative action during a public scandal amplifies parental perception of institutional complicity [12, 19, 29]. Offboarding policies should define clear thresholds for warnings, temporary suspensions, mandatory remediation training, and permanent contract terminations. When an offboarding action takes place, platform managers should communicate transparently with the subscriber community, framing the corrective action as a demonstration of institutional integrity and commitment to parental trust.

Finally, platform executives must measure governance effectiveness using specialized Key Performance Indicators alongside traditional SaaS metrics. Key metrics include the Value Alignment Score (evaluating catalog ethical compliance), the Ecosystem Risk Index (tracking creator off-platform vulnerability exposure), the Parent Trust Index (measuring subscriber confidence through periodic surveys), and the PFEW Churn Ratio (isolating moral cancellations from functional cancellations). Tracking these indicators ensures that governance remains a core executive priority rather than an operational afterthought.

9 Discussion, Implications, and Conclusion

9.1 Theoretical Contributions

This paper advances digital platform literature, platform governance theory, and consumer research through three primary conceptual contributions. First, it introduces the new theoretical construct of Parent-Funded Ethical Withdrawal (PFEW) as a specialized extension of Hirschman’s Exit-Voice-Loyalty model and ethical consumption theory [17, 19, 21]. PFEW identifies how subscription billing models convert third-party creator misbehavior into perceived parental moral complicity, explaining non-functional churn in values-driven platforms.

Second, the paper formulates the PFEW Causal Pathway Model, establishing a clear structural mechanism connecting macro-level platform enablement decisions to micro-level consumer exit behavior. By mapping how unmonitored creator autonomy leads to mission drift, trust erosion, and values-based subscription cancellation, this pathway provides researchers with a theoretical framework to analyze participant-generated risks in subscription ecosystems.

Third, the paper develops the Faith-Based Creator Governance Model (FCGM), offering a multi-tiered governance architecture that extends platform control theory beyond defensive, post-hoc content moderation [1, 2, 5]. FCGM demonstrates that platform stewardship in high-trust sectors requires continuous lifecycle governance across creator selection, auditing, consumer voice mechanisms, and alignment-based payout structures.

9.2 Boundary Conditions and Scope

The theoretical scope of this study is governed by explicit boundary conditions. PFEW operates primarily in high-involvement, values-driven subscription environments, such as faith-based educational technology, family media platforms, and ethical SaaS platforms, where purchasing stakeholders delegate moral stewardship to the platform operator. In these specialized ecosystems, consumers view subscription payments as moral endorsements of the platform’s underlying

ecosystem. Conversely, in low-involvement or purely utility-driven platforms, such as generic cloud storage or utility applications, standard functional churn models predominate, and consumer exit is governed primarily by price, convenience, and user experience.

9.3 Strategic Summary and Future Directions

In conclusion, this paper redefines the strategic risk architecture of faith-based children’s streaming platforms by demonstrating that the primary threat to long-term platform viability originates from creator governance vulnerabilities rather than simple content moderation failures. While creator enablement provides vital scaling velocity and creative diversity, unmonitored creator autonomy introduces ethical variability, mission drift, and reputational contagion. Left unchecked, these failure modes trigger Parent-Funded Ethical Withdrawal (PFEW), converting moral dissonance directly into subscription churn and customer lifetime value collapse. FCGM provides executive leaders with a strategic roadmap to align creator monetization incentives with institutional values.

Future empirical research should test and refine the constructs introduced in this conceptual framework. Quantitative studies utilizing Structural Equation Modeling can empirically evaluate the five conceptual propositions (P_1 to P_5), testing the structural paths connecting creator autonomy, content ethical variability, parental trust erosion, voice moderation, and PFEW exit intent. Qualitative multi-case studies examining operational implementations across different faith-conscious digital platforms will further illuminate the strategic trade-offs between creator enablement velocity and long-term brand equity preservation.

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